

SURESH PONSEKAR

Senior Product Owner & Program Manager — Payments | Client Connectivity | Real-Time Payments

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Chennai, India | Languages: **English** | **German** | Hindi | Tamil

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Product Owner and Program Manager with 13+ years in Transaction Banking and Payments across HSBC, Société Générale, Bank of America, RBS / NatWest, and Citi. Deep expertise across the payments product portfolio — SWIFT, ISO 20022, real-time payments (NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, UPI), Host-to-Host (H2H), API Banking, and client connectivity channels. Track record of leading large-scale product transformation and migration programmes, defining product roadmaps, prioritising backlogs, and driving delivery with risk, technology, operations, and compliance stakeholders across global and regional teams. Conversant in German, with experience working with European banking environments. Comfortable operating in ambiguous, cross-functional settings at scale.

CORE EXPERTISE

Payments & Connectivity: Client Connectivity | Host-to-Host (H2H) | API Banking | SWIFT (SAA, SAG, SNL, FIN, FileAct) | ISO 20022 / MX migration | Real-Time Payments | NEFT | RTGS | IMPS | UPI | NACH | EIPP | Virtual Accounts | Cash Management | Trade Finance (LC, BG, Collections) | Digital Transformation | Mobile App Development

Product Ownership & Delivery: Product Strategy | Product Roadmap | Product Backlog | User Stories & Acceptance Criteria | Sprint Planning | Product Governance | Go-to-Market | BRD / FSD | Business Case Development | Requirement Analysis | Stakeholder Management | Vendor Management

Risk, Compliance & Operations: RBI IT Examination | AML | KYC | Sanctions Screening | Cyber Security | VAPT (Nessus, Cyberport) | Production DR | Incident Management | CAB / Change Advisory | Audit & Controls | Regulatory Compliance

Tools & Methodology: JIRA | Confluence | ServiceNow | MS Project | Agile / Scrum / Kanban | SDLC / STLC | ITIL | Excel | PowerPoint

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MindGate Solutions | Senior Manager — Project & Program Management

Sep 2025 – Present | Chennai

- Lead delivery of cash management and payments solutions across multiple banking clients (Unity Bank, First Abu Dhabi Bank, Ajman Bank) and fintech partners (PayU); accountable for effort estimation, resource planning, risk management, and delivery readiness.
- Own product enhancements across VTransact DigiTB Cash Management — deposit booking and foreclosure, statement enquiry via Kafka, API Banking, H2H, NACH debit/credit, UPI collections, EIPP, bill payments, charges and settlements.
- Partner with banks and fintechs to define and launch next-generation payments propositions; work with sales to streamline revenue-generation leads and product positioning.
- Drive production DR, patching, and cyber-security activities to keep RTB and CTB workstreams compliant with RBI regulatory timelines.
- Driven E2E delivery of Digital Transformation of Cash management application & Mobile app development.

- Roll out Virtual Accounts and cash-management solutions for Indian and Gulf banks; ensure all trade workflows are delivered with full AML, KYC, and sanctions discipline.

LTIMindtree (Client: HSBC) | Senior Manager — SWIFT & India Payments

Oct 2022 – Sep 2025 | India

- Acted as **Product Owner** on HSBC core payments product roadmap covering SWIFT ISO 20022 migration and NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, UPI rollouts under the IFTAS / SFMS / RBI / NPCI ecosystem.
- Drove **client connectivity** workstreams across HSBC's payments channel estate — including **HSBC Channel Application** and **HSBC Digital Connect** — supporting H2H, API, and file-based corporate client integration.
- Prioritised product backlog, authored user stories with acceptance criteria, and set sprint goals; established Scrum teams with administrative and operational SOPs, raising delivery accuracy across JIRA / Confluence / ServiceNow.
- Led production DR planning, RBI IT examinations, physical threat modelling, penetration testing, product assurance testing, incident management, CAB releases, and full SDLC across the payments stack.
- Handled VAPT — CVE remediation with Nessus and Cyberport — and managed Linux / Oracle / Middleware / IBM patching plans across the payments app estate.
- Coordinated cross-functional stakeholders across IT, Operations, Risk, Compliance, and Finance to keep regulatory and operational risk inside agreed tolerance.

Société Générale GSC | SWIFT IT Project Manager

Apr 2021 – Oct 2022 | India

- Owned the project roadmap — objectives, timelines, milestones — for SWIFT application support and ISO 20022 onboarding across Société Générale's BIC estate.
- Executed ISO 20022 XML migration for major SG BICs, aligned to SWIFT MT 1XX / 2XX / 9XX message exchange; ensured FIN, MX, and FileAct flow enablement in SAA arrangements for each BIC.
- Implemented full SWIFT stack — SAA, SAG, SWIFT SNL, Workstation, MQ — for new SG entities and managed 10+ project teams in an Agile environment, applying SDLC / STLC discipline.
- Provided application support across SAA, SAG, PSG, INTIX, STARS, and SG back-office systems.

Bank of America (via Rangam Infotech / CPG BPM) | Networks Project Manager

Apr 2019 – Mar 2021 | India

- Rolled out UPI Payments and PSP handler onboarding at Bank of America; ran end-to-end project lifecycle for UPI, NEFT, RTGS 24x7, IDPMS, and EDPMS.
- Managed trade finance lifecycle workflows — Letters of Credit, Bank Guarantees, securities, shipping bills, settlements, collections, invoices, and back-office reporting.
- Improved project management processes, contributing to a 15% increase in team delivery efficiency; tracked delivery in JIRA and MS Project.

Royal Bank of Scotland (NatWest) | Process Lead & Subject Matter Expert

Jul 2017 – Oct 2018 | India

- Acted as business analyst on UAT and application implementation; translated stakeholder requirements into functional specifications, user stories, workflows, and data-model diagrams.
- Authored BRDs and FSDs for stakeholder sign-off; monitored team performance against KPI targets.

Tata Consultancy Services (Client: Citibank NA) | Senior Workflow Specialist

Oct 2012 – Jul 2017 | India

- Delivered payment histories, monthly statements, and proof-of-claim packs across default servicing for Citi customers in bankruptcy / automatic-stay.
- Managed internal QC, maker-checker controls, MIS, and daily production reporting.

SELECTED PROGRAMMES

- **NEFT, RTGS & ISO 20022 Migration** — HSBC
- **Client Connectivity & Channel Onboarding** — HSBC (HSBC Channel Application, HSBC Digital Connect)
- **SWIFT ISO 20022 Onboarding** — Société Générale
- **UPI Enablement** — Bank of America & HSBC
- **VTransact DigiTB Cash Management** — Unity Bank, First Abu Dhabi Bank, Ajman Bank
- **Group Accounts Automation** — RBS / NatWest

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MBA / PGDM — Anna University | 2017

B.Sc. — Loyola College, Chennai | 2012

Certifications

- Agile Certified Practitioner
- Agile Project Management with JIRA Cloud
- Initiating, Planning, Budgeting & Scheduling Projects
- Managing Project Risks & Changes
- Google Cloud Platform — Professional Cloud DevOps Engineer
- Lead Management and Leadership